

Tabloid TECH

People And Events That Grabbed The Headlines—For Better Or For Worse

Everything Paris!



Earlier in February, songstress and pop culture phenomenon Paris Hilton won a case to take down a Web site—ParisExposed.com—which was selling videos, pictures and personal data she'd left in some dark, dingy place! The site was shut down by an injunction, but the owner of the site, Bardia Persa, who had paid a pretty \$10 million for the booty, said he would contest the injunction!

Hilton said she was "mortified" that someone would try to "profit by exploiting personal details" about her, "especially when it comes to my sexuality." (!) We don't see what's to be mortified about! If someone bought something legally, we don't see why he *wouldn't* peddle it on the Net for profit!

Hilton's spokesman Elliott Mintz told Associated Press, "I know what this has done personally and emotionally to

Paris." We're supposed to feel sorry for her! And we bet you aren't!

So, well, the story continues: Persa duly appeared in court February 16, and the spoilsport judge again barred the site from peddling Hilton's racy photos, videos, diary entries, and other personal items.

There are lots more legalities! Which we can't understand! Actually, we don't even know what "injunction" means!

ParisExposed.com had promised subscribers glimpses of Hilton's personal records! It claimed to have footage of Hilton in a "sexy bubble bath," and shots of her in "racy situations"!

We bet you didn't figure why we're overdoing the exclamation marks! Well, it's just to get some oomph into this pointless story! The site's been blocked anyway, so who cares!

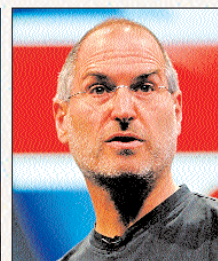
It's Cool Vs. Nerdy

There's a juicy Jobs/Gates feud doing the rounds, and it's based on a set of TV ads. You might have seen print ads of this sort—a geeky-looking man in a business suit, and beneath him, "I'm a PC"; and a "cool"-looking teenager on the right clad in jeans, and beneath him, "I'm a Mac." Similar to that are the new TV ads, but these actually use characters that look like Gates and Jobs. The nerdy guy, of course, looks like Gates.

Tech news Web site theregister.co.uk has called the long-standing feud between the two men a "tedious psychodrama between two megalomaniacs," and it all hinges around the idea that Jobs takes Gates' success personally.

In fact, Jobs once said, "The only problem with Microsoft is they just have no taste, they have absolutely no taste, and what that means is—I don't mean that in a small way I mean that in a big way."

Asked about the ads, Gates said he hadn't seen it. Then he said he had.



And then—fireworks! For no reason we can see... "I don't think the over 90 per cent of those who use Windows PCs think of themselves as dullards, or the kind of klutzes that somebody is trying to say they are," was the first thing Gates had to say. Why the insecurity? "And I don't know why (Apple is) acting like it's superior." Actually, that one's pretty obvious—because they have "cooler" products, isn't it?

"I don't even get it. What are they trying to say? Does honesty matter in these things, or if you're really cool, that means you get to be a lying person whenever you feel like it? There's not even the slightest shred of truth to it."

Not to worry, Bill. Even if we don't love you personally, we love our Windows. The Romanian president loves you too, by the way.

Ballmer Sinks MS Shares

Steve Ballmer recently said Wall Street's current expectations for revenue from Vista may be too "optimistic." Everyone around got that sinking feeling: Microsoft shares dropped more than 2 per cent shortly after.

"I'm really excited about how enthusiastic people are about Vista, but I think some of the revenue forecasts for Vista in 2008 are overly aggressive," Ballmer continued in the meeting for financial analysts.

We're not sure of the financial aspects of all this, but we get the general idea that Ballmer shouldn't (or needn't) have said what he did.

People also asked Ballmer about the Jobs vs. Gates TV ads. "I'll give Apple credit for what it's done," Ballmer said. It's not like they've really grown a lot of market share (through the commercials).



"Remember, when you're the little tiny niche guy who owns about 2 per cent of the worldwide market, you can be cute one time and it helps you grow."

Now that sounds more like the Ballmer we know. "Little tiny niche guy?"